

IMPACT OF STRUCTURAL ORGANISATION ON MEANING REALISATION IN SELECTED DEFECTION SPEECHES OF NIGERIAN POLITICIANS

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Abstract

There is a recent upsurge in incidents of political party defection in Nigeria. Prominent politicians make speeches as they celebrate their movement from one party to another. Several studies have been carried out on political party defection from different perspectives, but little or nothing seems to have been done on language structuring and meaning making in defection speeches. On this note, this study relied on the insights from Systemic Functional Linguistic Theory in the investigation of the genre, textuality, grammaticality and ideologies that influence defection speeches in Nigerian politics. Convenience sampling technique is adopted in the selection of the data from online Newspapers. The sampling is done through the use of Google search engine. Descriptive survey design adopted enabled an unbiased data analysis. The results indicated that the speeches are formal; structurally organised; cohesive and meaningfully written. They also appeared to be persuasively manipulative and ideologically motivated which is characteristic of public speeches. Based on the results, it is concluded that defection speech in Nigerian politics is a form of political advertisement that projects a desired political party or candidate. This study recommended the use of combined semiotic and semantic components of SFL (Mode-cum-Textual Analytics) for a more comprehensive analysis of the discourse structure of texts.

Key words: Mode, textuality, meaning, defection speech and Nigerian politics.

Introduction

There is a recent upsurge in incidents of political party defection in Nigeria. Prominent politicians in Nigeria seem to celebrate their movement from one political party to another. And they make speeches to mark their defections.

Political party defection is actually a democratic process that is practiced in many countries including Nigeria but the recent spate of it among the top Nigerian politicians, from and to the two major political parties (APC and PDP) in Nigeria is overwhelming and thought provoking. The number and calibre of politicians involved in the incessant camp-switching, and what Ismail and Ikani (2018) referred to as verbal war which they engage themselves in, leave one with no other option than to wonder and worry about the implication of this recent fad to the democratic consolidation of Nigeria. Below are the identified speeches made by some prominent politicians who switched camps in recent times.

- a) The Imperative of a New Broader Platform – Full Text of Mimiko's Defection Speech (October 2, 2014)

- b) Ex-Governor Peter Obi Defects to PDP (October 7, 2014)
- c) FULL TEXT: Rivers Deputy Governor, Ikuru's Defection Speech (March 22, 2015)
- d) Senator Uzamere's Defection Speech (August 2, 2016)
- e) My Defection to APC not for Political Appointment – Olagunsoye Oyinlola (August 27, 2016)
- f) Why I Returned to Labour Party – Mimiko (June 15, 2018)
- g) Why I Dumped APC for PDP – Ortom (July 26, 2018)
- h) Saraki's Speech after Dumping APC for PDP (July 31, 2018)
- i) 10 Takeaways from Tambuwal's Defection Speech (August 1, 2018)
- j) Why I Defected to APC – Godswill Akpabio (August 8, 2018)
- k) Kwara Gov. – Abdulfatah Ahmed – Explains Why he Left APC for PDP (August 8, 2018)
- l) Full Text of Uduaghan 'John the Baptist' Defection Speech (August 29, 2018)
- m) Labour Party Presidential Candidate – Sam Nwanti – Declares Support for Buhari, Defects to APC (December 2, 2018)
- n) Senator Elisha Ishaku Abbo Dumps PDP for APC (November 25, 2020)
- o) Ayade: Why I Dumped PDP for APC (May 20, 2021)

Political party defection is as old as multi-party system but seems to have become massive and incessant in Nigerian politics since 2013 – President Goodluck Jonathan's regime. The formation of All Progressives Congress Party and the division/fractionalisation in PDP in 2013 seem to have escalated the rate of mass defection among the politicians in Nigeria. Up to 11 senators and 37 members of the house of representative defected to the new opposition party – APC (BBC, 2014). Several politicians have switched camps between 2013 and 2020 but only a few of them made speeches at the points of defection. The list above indicates those who made speeches. The titles of the speeches appeared mostly as minor and bound clauses. Therefore, the examination of the structural organisation that depicts meaning and also projects political ideologies becomes necessary.

Statement of the Problem

Scholars have investigated speeches, politics of defection and political discourse from different perspectives – spate, rationale, aftermaths, features, styles, identity and ideological projections – (Kamalu & Udeh, 2013; Anurudu & Lawal, 2014; Badejo, Agunyai & Buraimo, 2016; Ayoola & Babatunde, 2018; Abah, 2018; Gabriel, 2018; Oparah, 2018, etc). More studies may be currently in progress, yet little or nothing seems to have been done on the effect of language structure on meaning making in defection speeches. On this note, this study focused on closing the identified lacuna in Linguistics.

Aim and Objectives of the Study

The aim of this study is to investigating the impact of structural organisation on meaning realisation in the selected defection speeches in Nigerian politics. The objectives of the study are, to:

- i) establish the characteristics that distinguish the selected speeches as studiable.
- ii) investigate the mode of discourse in the selected speeches.

- iii) identify the ideological motivations in the speeches.
- iv) establish the functional implications of persuasion in Nigerian politics

Research Questions

The following research questions enabled the development of this study:

- i) what are the characteristics that distinguished the selected speeches as objects of study?
- ii) what is the mode of discourse adopted in the selected speeches?
- iii) what are the ideological motivations in the selected speeches?
- iv) what are the functional implications of persuasion in Nigerian politics?

Significance of the Study

This study has contributed to knowledge in theory and practice. In theory, the study advances the Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL). It projects the use of combined semiotic and semantic components of the SFL (Mode-cum-Textual Analytics) for more comprehensive textual analysis.

In practice, the study has clarified the categories of structural organisation of discourses. It has added to the resource materials that serve as guides for further studies on defection speech in particular and political discourse in general. It also serves as a guide for effective communication, image making and identity construction in politicking.

Theoretical Support

This study lent credence from Halliday's Systemic Functional Linguistic Theory in the investigation of the structural organisation of the selected defection speeches that expressed meaning and projected ideologies of the defectors. Through the influence of Malinowski and Firth, the British linguist, M. A. K Halliday, developed Systemic Functional Linguistics in the 1960s (Nordquist, 2018). SFL proposed the interrelatedness of language and the context that produces it. In other words, both linguistic properties that constitute a discourse and the context that informs the discourse contribute in making meaning explicit in every discourse.

Halliday's Systemic Functional Linguistics is broadly analysed into three metafunctions: ideational, interpersonal, and textual. Koussouhon and Dossoumou (2015) contended, in agreement with Halliday and Matthiessen (2004), that the interpersonal metafunction is the grammar of language in use that not only enables us to express our inner and outer experiences of the world but also allows our interaction with people which includes creating relationships. Ayoola and Babatunde (2018) argued that the textual metafunction, which relates to the mode of a text (the internal organisation and communicative nature of a text), enables the understanding of the ideational and interpersonal features of a text. In other words, the textual metafunction is believed to be playing a major part in the overall creation of meaning in communication.

Whether one is playing a major or minor function, it has been noted that the notion of metafunction refers to three separate strands of meaning that contribute to the overall meaning in every text, as Whitelaw and Argamon (2004) submitted. It is worth noting, therefore, that text, in this context, refers to both spoken and written discourse. And the three identified metafunctions point towards how best language is used to achieve meaning in the various discourse situations.

In consonance with the established interconnectedness of language structure and the social structure that produce it (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2004; Banks, 2016), Kamalu (2018) identified a classification of the contextual and functional features of language as consisting of the following:

Contextual (Semiotic) Features		Functional (Semantic) Features	
(a)	Field of discourse		Ideational function
(b)	Tenor of discourse		Interpersonal function
(c)	Mode of discourse		Textual function

Based on the above classification Elendu (2022) proposed the combined semiotic (contextual) and semantic (functional) components of the SFL (Mode-cum-Textual Analytics; Tenor-cum-Interpersonal Analytics, and Field-cum-Ideational Analytics) as analytical tools for more comprehensive linguistic analysis. The combination matches field of discourse with ideational metafunction; tenor of discourse with interpersonal metafunction, and mode of discourse with textual metafunction respectively based on the interrelatedness of the language structure and the social context of message production. This study, therefore, adopted the Mode-cum-Textual Analytics in the examination of the ideological projection and meaning realisation in relation to the structural organisation of the selected defection speeches.

Related Concepts

Discourse Mode, Language, Textuality and Meaning in Discourses.

As one of the most important aspects of human attributes, language is structurally and functionally developed into a definite instrument of expression and communication. The primary purpose of language is for communication of thoughts, ideas, beliefs and interests of an individual or group of individuals. It plays several other vital roles in the society, like relating our intentions and perceptions about life in a given society. Society, on the other hand, relies on language for its development or destruction, as the case may be.

Language use varies according to the mode of communication – pictorial, spoken or written medium. In spoken discourse, for instance, the choice of informal forms of expression, such as contractions (can't, isn't, couldn't, shouldn't, etc), repetitions and pauses, is permissible. On the contrary, written discourse appears to follow more strict order than spoken discourse, thus characterised by formal forms of expression. In addition, mode enables the analyst to ascertain whether a text falls within the short or long, meaningful or meaningless, rhetorical (persuasive) or plain discourse (Sunardi, 2006; Kamalu, 2018). This heightens the relevance of mode as a tool for textual analysis.

Textuality refers to the characteristics that make a text studiable. It accounts for the investigation of contextual and linguistic features that portray a text as a meaningful written, spoken or pictorial communication. It enables the construction of contextually relevant texts. According to Ayoola and Babatunde (2018), it links the mode, the internal organisation and communicative nature of the text. It also involves the thematic structure, information structure, and cohesion (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2004; Banks, 2016; Syal & Jindal, 2016). A structurally organised text is one that is studiable and meaningful. This makes textuality an indispensable

aspect of discourse analysis.

Defection Speech and Political Discourse.

An inquiry into the political party defection in Nigerian is not supposed to end in a search for the reason(s) for such massive camp switching by Nigerian politicians, but should extend to how language is employed in the communication of the reason(s). One way of carrying out such investigation is through an examination of the discourse structure – theme/rheme development; how known and unknown information is related in the discourse and cohesion. This is the perspective this study has taken in the examination of the speeches made by the political defectors.

Defection speeches are forms of political discourse (advertisement) as such they are usually either exhortative or dehortative in nature, or even a combination of both, depending on the speaker's or writer's style (Kamalu, 2018). In other words, the linguistic choices in defection speeches are expected to be structured in such a way that the electorates are either urged strongly towards favouring the particular party or individual of the defector's choice, or dissuaded from looking towards the other direction (abandoned party). This means that the language of political advertisement performs persuasive and dissuasive functions as the case may be. It is, therefore, worthwhile to note that political discourse, as a field of human activity has its peculiar vocabulary. Political advertisement, which is parts of political discourse, is geared towards persuading and influencing the voting patterns of the electorates (Ayoola & Babatunde, 2018). Beyond the reliance of the society on language for social growth and vibrancy, language lends itself to creative manipulations in both spoken and written communications to capture the changing dynamics of the society and diverse linguistic needs of the speaker/writer in different contexts.

The recent defection of politicians to PDP, according to Ismail and Ikani (2018), did not go down well with some members of the ruling party (APC) who levelled barrage of criticism on the defectors and also attacked some of them based on the presumed role they played in the switch of camps. Prominent politicians seem to exert heavy influence on their loyalists which makes them to move alongside these godfathers at every instance of defection to other parties. An example of such is former Senate President Bukola Saraki's case. A political culture as this, can neither give room for political ideologies to thrive nor encourage democratic consolidation of the Country. Rather, if not well handled, it could create hostile inter-party relationships, ripple effects and social unrest.

Political advertisement is one type of advertisement that can be classified under the Ayoola and Babatunde's (2018) non-commercial adverts. It does not involve direct buying and selling, but communication of ideas and interests, either of groups or of individuals, to the public in order to manipulate political actions. This could be aimed at either the promotion of some political aspirants, political parties, or political programmes. In other words, the purpose of political advertisement could either be to create public awareness or political propaganda. In whichever way, its ultimate goal is to attract the attention and interest of the electorate through persuasive language.

Related Studies

Identity and Ideological Speeches; Politics of Defection, and Language of Advertisement

Scholars have carried out several related studies that formed the basis for this study. Kamalu and Udeh carried out a stylistic and critical linguistic analysis of Bishop David Oyedepo's Induction and Matriculation speeches in 2013. Insights from SFL and CDA enabled the investigation. The study revealed that linguistic choices enabled the Bishop to communicate his ideologies effectively.

Anurudu and Lawal also investigated Abraham Lincoln's and Barack Obama's Gettysburg Speech and 2009 Inaugural Speech at Chicago respectively in 2014. SFG, Austin's Speech Act Theory and Grice's Theory of Implicature were adopted in the study. Anurudu and Lawal's (2014) study relates to the present study in the sense that both are speech analyses. They fall within the three identified Aristotelian Rhetoric – Epideictic, Deliberative and Forensic. However, Lincoln's Gettysburg Speech and Obama's 2009 Inaugural Speech are examples of Epideictic Rhetoric which deals with ceremonial matters and focuses on establishing honour/praises. The present study, on the other hand, exemplifies Deliberative Rhetoric – political rhetoric that establishes the expediency or harmfulness of a proposed cause of action (Kamalu, 2018).

Moyi (2018) is another speech analysis that examined the use of language by Nigerian politicians. It is a study of President Goodluck Ebele Jonathan's 2012 Democracy Day Speech. Using the Speech Act and Politeness Theories, Moyi examined ex-President Jonathan's Democratic Day Speech in 2018. These are all studies on speech but different speeches are examined. The present study is on defection speeches based on a different theory – SFL.

Badejo, Agunyai and Buraimo (2016), and Volpi (2019) carried out studies on political party defection respectively. However, the first study examined the politics and rationale of party switching in Nigeria leaning on the Zero-Sum Game of Game Theory. The second one investigated the historical evolution, causes and difference between individual and group defections. None of these studies focused on language use which is the concern of the present study.

The studies on political advertisement reviewed in the present study (Ndimele and Owuamalam 2015; Ayoola and Babatunde 2018; Ikeke 2021) examined the language of political advertisement from various perspectives different from the perspective of the present study. In 2015, Ndimele and Owuamalam investigated the Nigerian Television Authority's April 2015 network programme – 'See who wants to be President of Nigeria'. Based on insights from the Textual Metafunctional aspect of the SFL, the thematic analysis of adverts of the two major political parties during the 2011 general elections was carried out by Ayoola and Babatunde in 2018. In 2021, Ikeke also investigated the use and misuse of language in political campaign in Nigeria. Dialogical and Monological Theories of relationship interaction in communication was adopted. However, this study gained insight from SFL in the examination of the impact of structural organisation on meaning realisation in the selected speeches. The ideological motivations and implications of persuasion in Nigerian politics were also examined in the present study.

Research Methodology

Descriptive survey design was adopted in this qualitative research. This involves the collection and description of certain features of the data (which are of interest to the researcher), as they are at the time of the study without any manipulation (Nwankwo, 2013). The population for the study, which refers to the group of elements (individuals, events, ideas, or objects) that form the criteria for the generalisation of the research result (Nwankwo, 2013; Mbah, 2016), is thirty (30) written defection speeches between 1999 and 2021.

A non-probability sampling method known as convenience sampling technique was adopted in drawing the sample for analysis which is fifteen speeches of some prominent politicians who defected from and to the two major political parties (APC and PDP) in Nigeria. It is a method where data is drawn from the population that is conveniently available (Etikan, 2016).

Based on the unavailability of a comprehensive database for the documents, Google search engine was used in the collection of the data from online Newspapers. The data for analysis were tagged S1-S15 (where S represents sample – speech). The titles and the main body of the speeches were treated as the Theme and Rheme of the thematic and information structure respectively instead of all the clauses in the speeches. This means that the titles were viewed as the Theme and Given/Known parts of the thematic and information structures while the main body (content) of the speeches were treated as the Rheme and New/Unknown parts of the message. This is based on the fact that the Theme, just like the title, refers to the heading to what the message is all about which also defines the angle of the content (Downing, 2015). Both the thematic and information structural meanings are also realisable through the title/content level as it is with the clause level.

Analysis and Discussion of Findings

S/n	Groups	Defection Speeches	Original Parties	Parties Defected to
S1	A	The Imperative of a New Broader Platform – Full Text of Mimiko's Defection Speech	LP	PDP
S2		Ex-Governor Peter Obi Defects to PDP	APGA	PDP
S3		Full Text: Rivers Deputy Governor, Ikuru's Defection Speech	APC	PDP
S4		Why I Defected to APC – Godswill Akpabio	PDP	APC
S5			PDP	APC
S6			PDP	APC
S7				LP
S8	B	Senator Uzamere's Defection Speech	PDP	APC
S9		My Defection to APC not for Political Appointment	PDP	APC
S10			PDP	APC
S11		Full Text of Uduaghan 'John the Baptist' Defection Speech	PDP	APC

S12		Labour Party Presidential Candidate Declares Support for Buhari, Defects to APC	LP	APC
S13		Senator Elisha Ishaku Abbo Dumps PDP for APC	PDP	APC
S14		Ayade: Why I Dumped PDP for APC	PDP	APC
S15	C	Why I Returned to Labour Party	PDP	

Table 1: Grouping of Data Based on Parties Defected to

Data analysis was based on the objectives that formed the research questions in the study. **Mode-cum-Textual analytics** is adopted in this study. It is an analytical tool formed from a combination of the semiotic and semantic components of the Hallidayan Systemic Functional Linguistics (Elendu, 2022). It accounts for the medium adopted in communication (say written, spoken, or pictorial) and the structural organisation (thematic, information and cohesion) of the text that makes meaning comprehensible. In addition, mode enables the analyst to ascertain whether a text falls within the short or long, meaningful or meaningless, rhetorical (persuasive) or plain discourse (Sunardi, 2006; Kamalu, 2018). In sum, this analytical tool provides the focal lens for classifying and viewing the structural organisation of the selected defection speeches as indicated below.

Features that Distinguished the Selected Defection Speeches as Objects of Study

Textuality is viewed as the complex set of features that enable a text to be considered as text (Neubert & Shreve, 1992, as cited in Nordquist, 2019c). Three basic domains of textuality – structure, texture and context – are considered in this speech analysis. Structure and texture revolve around the outline (**thematic structure, information structure and cohesion**) that is developed into the speeches under study. Context, on the other hand, refers to the semiotic factors that determine specific rhetorical and functional purposes of the speeches.

Simple and Unmarked Themes

S2	Ex-Governor Peter Obi	defects to PDP
S7	Kwara Gov.	explains why he left APC for PDP
S12	Labour Party presidential candidate	declares support for Buhari
S13	Senator Elisha Ishaku Abbo	dumps PDP for APC
	Theme	Rheme

Table 2 : Illustration of Clauses with Simple and Unmarked Themes in the Speeches.

Multiple Themes

S4		Why	I	dumped APC for PDP – Ortom
S10		Why	I	defected to APC – Godswill Akpabio
S14	Ayade:	why	I	dumped PDP for APC
S15		Why	I	returned to Labour Party
	Interpersonal	Topical		
	Theme			Rheme

Table 3: Illustration of Bound Clauses with Finite Verbs and Multiple Themes in the Speeches. Out of the fifteen (15) samples (titles of the speeches), four (**S2, S7, S12, & S13**) analysed above are identified as having simple Themes. Simple Theme is made up of an indivisible structural element (a word, a phrase or a group of words) that coexists with the initial constituent of the mood structure in a declarative sentence (Dowing, 2015). In other words, the Themes in **S2, S7, S12, and S13** above are mapped on to the subjects.

According to Halliday and Matthiessen (2004), the mapping of a Theme on to the subject of a declarative clause accounts for its unmarkedness. On the other hand, when the Theme of the declarative sentence is anything other than the subject, it is termed marked. What occupied the initial positions of the clauses (titles of **S2, S7, S12, & S13**) are simple subjects that are normal and expected in transitivity structures. Hence, the Themes are simple and unmarked.

The clauses (**S4, S10, S14 and S15**) analysed above are not treated as minor clauses because they are dependent clauses that have finite verbs. They also express mood and transitivity which is an indicator of thematic structure in a clause (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2004). The clauses also depict more than one subject which is an indication of the multiplicity of the Themes. Apart from **S14**, which has a vocative element (Ayade) and could be interpreted to mean 'This is Ayade's reason for dumping PDP for APC', the other three speech titles identified above could be interpreted as follows:

S4 This is why I dumped APC for PDP-Ortom

S10 This is why I defected to APC-Godswill Akpabio

S15 This is why I returned to Labour Party

Whether 'This is' is added to the bound clauses or not, they appear to have function in the transitivity structure of the clause. There are actors, processes and circumstantial elements in the clauses therefore; the messages are communicated in a Theme-Rheme progression.

The remaining seven clauses (titles of **S1, S3, S5, S6, S8, S9, & S11**) are viewed as

minor clauses based on their fragmented nature. They are as follows:

- S1** The imperative of a new broader platform-Full text of Mimiko's defection speech
- S3** Ikuru's defection speech
- S5** Saraki's speech after dumping APC for PDP
- S6** 10 takeaways from Tambuwal's defection speech
- S8** Senator Uzamere's defection speech
- S9** My defection to APC not for political appointment
- S11** Full text of Uduaghan 'John the Baptist' defection speech

The clauses listed above are titles of speeches as such; they serve specific and important purposes like attracting the addressee's attention. They lack transitivity structure and thematic structure therefore; they are treated as minor clauses.

A minor clause is an incomplete sentence that expresses thought. It has no finite verb. It is used more often in oral discourse and tweets than in formal written discourse. Minor clause or sentence refers to an irregular way of expressing thought in some discourse situations. 'Minor', as a term, is used to describe abbreviated clauses; fragmented sentences; elliptical and incomplete clauses that still express meaning in discourses (Bloomfield, 1933, Nida, 1943 & 1966, as cited in Nordquist, 2019b). Based on these assertions, minor clauses could refer to the social media (internet) language that communicates meaning based on the context of its use. The choice of minor clauses in the titles of the speeches is characteristic of media discourse.

Given-New is another aspect of text structures that accounts for orderliness and meaningfulness in message construction. Given refers to the information which the sender of a message thinks that the receiver of the message knows already while New borders on the aspect of the message the sender assumes to be unknown to the receiver as illustrated below.

S2	Ex-Governor Peter Obi defects	to PDP
S7	Kwara Gov. explains why he left	APC to PDP
S12	Labour Party presidential candidate declares support	for Buhari, defects to APC
S13	Senator Elisha Ishaku Abbo dumps	PDP for APC
Given		New

Table 4: Illustration of Given and New Information in the Speeches through Some Titles.

Relating the Givenness in the information structure with the samples (**S2**, **S7**, **S12** & **S13**) above, we can deduce that there is denotation of expressions in the immediate contexts of language use. Based on the topic of discourse and the immediate context that refers to the already known information, the understanding of what is new is therefore made easy.

Apart from the major clauses categorised into Given and New above, other sample data are bound and minor clauses. As such, they could be viewed as Given information while the rest of the messages constitute the New information communicated in the speeches.

Cohesion is an important aspect of textuality that accounts for the connectedness; meaningfulness and meaninglessness of the message. It involves the interpretation of an element of the text in connection with another/other elements in the same text. The instances of cohesion in texts take two forms – grammatical and lexical forms. While grammatical cohesion comprises the use of conjunction; reference; and ellipsis/substitution, lexical cohesion refers to the lexical relation in the lexicogrammar of the text through reiteration (repetition) and collocation (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2004; Omolara, 2005; Hameed, 2008; Syal & Jindal, 2016, & Benzoukh, 2017). The grammatical and lexical cohesion in the selected speeches is achieved through the linguistic devices that established continuity of sense that enabled sentences to be meaningful and functional.

Conjunction and reference are important linkers/markers that serve connectivity and continuity purposes in the speeches under study. The conjunctions listed below appeared severally in all the data:

- a) Additives – and, too, also etc.
- b) Adversatives – but, however, yet, etc.
- c) Causals – therefore, since, because, etc.
- d) Spatiotemporals – now, then, meanwhile, today, etc.

Such words (of course, even so, perhaps, beyond that, rather than, indeed, etc) that express some levels of continuity are also identified in the samples.

Several reference items that enable the introduction of elements of discourse (participants and events) and keep track of them throughout the discourse are identified in the speeches. They are exemplified below.

- a) Pronoun – you/your, they/themselves/their, it/its, he/his/him, and we.
- b) Demonstratives – the/this/these and that.
- c) Comparatives – better, same, topmost, and such.

The above listed reference elements (words) are used to points outside the text but within its context and bring some elements of discourse into the speeches (exophoric reference). They also enable the picking up of the elements introduced into the speeches and keeping track of them throughout the discourse. Anaphoric reference refers back within the text while cataphoric reference refers forward as the text develops (Halliday & Hasan, 1976; Halliday & Matthiessen, 2004).

Ellipsis and substitution are other forms of grammatical cohesion. They are variants of a type of cohesive relation. They create cohesive links between elements of meaning at the level of wording (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2004). They operate at the nominal group, verbal group and clausal level of the sentence. While substitution refers to the replacement of one textual element with another such as; one(s)/same, do/do so, so/not, etc, ellipsis is viewed as substitution by deletion. It is characterised by omission of lexical item(s) in some grammatical environments. Below are examples of instances of ellipsis and substitution in some of the speeches under study.

(i) “...the nation goes on hurting; and our democratic institutions go on cranking under undue pressure. Even **so**, I am...” (paragraphs 1 & 2 of **S1**). **So** as used above presupposes the entire clause (the nation goes on hurting...) as exemplified above. An entire clause is replaced

with the word **so**. By so doing, there is reference and connection to the existing clause by substitution – clausal substitution.

(ii) “...Rivers People supporting leaders...we were the same [Ø] that witch hunted...” (paragraph 6 of **S3**). As illustrated above (People), used in the nominal group of the first part of the example, is omitted in the second part. Hence, nominal ellipsis is employed for cohesive purposes.

As established above, ellipsis and substitution are variants of the same type of cohesive relation. They are used to refer to what has gone before in the speeches either by the use of a word to replace a noun or entire clause, or by omitting the word or entire clause to presuppose what has been stated earlier in the same speech. The various grammatical environments determined the uses as exemplified above.

Reiteration and collocation are types of lexical cohesion that aid meaning realisation as exemplified in the speeches under study. Reiteration refers to the repetition or reoccurrence of lexical items in discourses. It can occur in form of inflection (grammatical change in form based on the function of a word – gender, number or tense) or derivation (grammatical change that produces a new word form through affixation). It can also be achieved through the use of synonyms and repetition of sentence structures for emphasis and cohesion in texts (Halliday & Matthiessen, 2004, & Nordquist, 2019a). Several words are repeated in these forms in the data. For instance:

S1: Derivation – “democracy/democratic/democratisation”.

Synonyms – “country/land/nation”.

Sentence Structures – “...goes on hurting...go on cranking...” (paragraph 1).

“...the Jonathan presidential project...the Jonathan reforms...the Jonathan administration...the Jonathan presidency...” (paragraphs 8 & 9). “In the agriculture sector....In the transportation sector...” (paragraphs 8 & 9). The understanding of the word democracy connects to the understanding of democratic and democratisation as having something to do with democracy.

Collocation refers to the instances of lexical cohesion by association or co-occurrence of lexical items in discourses. It has to do with a considerable lexico-semantic relation such as; synonym/antonym; hypernym/hyponym, and holonym/meronym. An instance of their use in the speeches is exemplified below.

S1: synonyms – “free and fair election” and “the weak and the disadvantaged”.

Antonyms – “market men and women”.

S5: Meronymy – “legislature and government” and “democracy and constitution”.

As indicated above, words that share similarities and differences in meanings are juxtaposed for cohesive purposes in the speeches. This enables the interpretation of the meaning of some lexical items in connection with the existence of another or others. The identified forms of collocation in the speeches are also for emphasis, clarity and cohesion.

Discourse Mode Adopted in the Selected Defection Speeches

Speeches	Spoken	Written	Formal	Informal	Persuasive	Plain	Long	Short
S1	-	+	+	-	+	-	+	-
S2	-	+	+	-	+	-	-	+
S3	-	+	+	-	+	-	+	-
S4	-	+	+	-	-	+	-	+
S5	-	+	+	-	+	-	+	-
S6	-	+	+	-	+	-	+	-
S7	-	+	+	-	+	-	-	+
S8	-	+	+	-	+	-	+	-
S9	-	+	+	-	-	+	-	+
S10	-	+	+	-	+	-	-	+
S11	-	+	+	-	+	-	+	-
S12	-	+	+	-	+	-	-	+
S13	-	+	+	-	+	-	-	+
S14	-	+	+	-	+	-	-	+
S15	-	+	+	-	+	-	+	-

Table 5: Classification of the Defection Speeches According to Mode of Discourse (Genre)

The table above indicate that the mode of discourse adopted in the data are written medium. Though majority of the speeches appear to have been presented orally at the point of defection and were later reported on the pages of the various newspapers. For instance; **S2, S4, S7, S9, S10, S12, S13 and S14** are written in the language of reportage while the direct speeches of the defectors appeared in quotes. Other sample speeches (**S1, S3, S5, S6, S8, S11, & S15**) appear to be written and then read at the points of defection. Therefore, the data are identified as written documents.

The defection speeches under study are written in the ordinary forms of discourses – no metrical structures, no dramatic techniques. Some are persuasive enough to convince the reader towards a certain point of view; others are didactic, while a few are simply explanatory. Some are long while others are short. Each speech presents a central argument; evidence(s) to support the claim and conclusion that summarised the message. In sum, they displayed some features of public speeches as such they are formal and written public speeches.

Ideological Motivations in the Selected Speeches

	S1	S2	S3	S4	S5	S6	S7	S8	S9	S10	S11	S12	S13	S14	S15	
Positive image	+	-	-	-	-	-	+	-	-	-	+	-	+	-	+	Transparent ideology
Negative image	-	-	-	-	+	+	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	
Discrimination	-	-	+	-	+	-	-	-	-	+	-	-	-	-	-	
Hate speech	-	-	+	-	-	+	-	-	-	-	-	-	+	-	-	
Gate-keeping	+	-	-	+	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	Opaque ideology
Marginalisation	+	+	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	+	-	
Hegemony	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	+	-	-	
Evasion	-	+	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	

Table 6: Classification of Ideological Representation in the Speeches

Every use of language is ideologically motivated and words are carefully selected to transmit ideology and meaning in discourses. However, it is important to emphasise that meaning has linguistic and extra-linguistic perspectives (Wale, 2005; Syal & Jindals, 2016). There is meaning in both what is said directly and indirectly. It is conceived within us and largely informed by our knowledge of the world around us. This is based on the fact that the contexts of meaning production control the linguistic choices that transmit ideology and meaning in that same context.

There are transparent and Opaque ideologies that account for the denotative and connotative meanings realised in the speeches as indicated above. Transparent ideologies are indicated through positive image making; negative image making; discrimination and hate speeches. These different ideologies reflected through the words used in the speeches. An instance of this is S3 (ex-deputy Governor Ikuru's speech):

“After carefully studying, interacting and analysing the leadership of the party, I have come to the sad conclusion that the **APC is a party of rebels, insurgents and anarchists, clothed in robes of pretence and deceit. APC is a party founded on deception and it thrives on unholy propaganda and falsehood**” (paragraph 4). ”

Apart from the hate speech identified above, Ikuru's speech is replete with other forms of emotional blackmail and other forms of persuasive and manipulative strategies to garner the Rivers State people's political support for ex-president Goodluck Jonathan.

There are instances of the various forms of transparent and opaque ideological representations in all the speeches. This is an indication of the politicians' ideological positions meant to influence the political actions of their listeners and readers.

Functional Implications of Persuasion in Nigerian Politics.

The application of semantic choices such as cajoling, enticing, insisting, exhorting, dehorting, etc, in the speeches under study is strategically persuasive. These choices are embedded in the

arguments put up in the speeches as reasons for the defections. Persuasion is an act of influencing people's thoughts and/or manipulating their opinions in situated contexts. It is used to sustain, maintain or intensify the attitudes or behaviour of people (Kamalu & Udeh, 2013). Apart from sustaining, maintaining and/or intensifying the attitudes, it could perform the following communicative functions in Nigerian politics.

- ❖ Creation of political awareness
- ❖ Creation of political propaganda
- ❖ Creation of a vicious cycle of politics attack
- ❖ Engendering voters' apathy towards democratic processes
- ❖ Increasing hostile inter-party relationship, unhealthy rivalry and social unrest

Political awareness could be created through a clear cut, historical, informative and logical persuasion. This is instantiated in **S1**, **S5**, **S8**, **S11** and **S13**. Such speeches could provide valuable information about the political parties as well as promote democratic processes in Nigeria.

Propaganda could be misleading and deceptive. Negative persuasion (name-calling, hate-speech, etc) could invent what Hasrama (2016) referred to as vicious cycle of politics attack. Resorting to the use of words that are image damaging, as evidenced in **S3**, **S6** and **S13**, could lead to unnecessary retaliation. In the long run, violent cycle of such attack may ensue. It could also lead to lack of interest in democratic and political processes. In such situation the power of civic duty and voting turnout may reduce.

Attack on person(s) which has become part of persuasion increases hostility and unhealthy competitions among politicians. It boomerangs in most cases to work against the attacker by creating a negative image of him/her before the targeted audience, therefore, language users should be mindful of the linguistic choices they make in discourses.

Conclusion

The findings of this study indicated that the speeches are structurally organised, formal, meaningful, and written public speeches. They are persuasively manipulative. Therefore, defection speech is viewed as a form of political advertisement (campaign) aimed at projecting a desired party or candidate.

Recommendations

The use of combined contextual and functional components of the Systemic Functional Linguistic theory (Mode-cum-Textual Analytics) is recommended for more comprehensive linguistic analysis. There is need for more studies on defection speeches so that more awareness will be created on the consequences of derogation (name-calling and hate speech) in politics. Studies on image making and identity construction in defection speeches would guide language users aright. A comparative study of election campaign and defection speech is also recommended. This will strengthen the assertion that defection speech is a form of political advertisement and also clarify the categories of political advertisement.

Contributions to knowledge

Apart from filling the existing gap and adding to the existing studies in linguistics, this study

advances the Systemic Functional Linguistic Theory by proposing the use of combined SFL analytical tool (Mode-cum-Textual Analytics) for more encompassing linguistic analysis of discourses.

The study provides guide for further studies in defection speeches as forms of political advertisement. It guides politicians aright in image making and identity construction in politicking. It also draws its readers' attention to the fact that systemic choice probabilities vary with contextual factors therefore, linguistic choices should be made in line with the intended communicative functions.

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